Mary Cris Tapic | Operations & financial administration · Case study

Year-end shouldn’t be a scavenger hunt.

A construction owner needed someone to keep the office side moving while he ran the business. I kept subcontractor paperwork moving through the year, verified records before chasing anyone, and handed him documents ready to file.

My role
Admin, light bookkeeping, document collection, follow-up

Tools
QuickBooks Online, Drive, Sheets, Leap, email, text, VoIP

Period
2022–2026, supporting one construction owner

What it was like before

Subcontractor paperwork arrived through email, text, Leap customer files, and the owners' own computers.

A missing W-9 or agreement usually surfaced at year-end, when the filing was due.

Payment records and contractor documents lived in different places, so totals had to be rebuilt each year.

What I handled

Inbox

Triaged bank, vendor and customer emails and tickets. Replied for the owner on important matters.

Job tracking

Kept jobs, files, tasks and follow-ups current in Leap and Google Sheets.

Light bookkeeping

QuickBooks Online (2022): invoices, bills, transaction categories, payment matching, reconciliations.

Subcontractor paperwork

Requested W-9s and contractor agreements, typically 5+ a month, filed per contractor. The owner filed the 1099s.

Year-end support

Compiled each year's expenses by category in a master tax workup sheet, matched to receipts.

Follow-up

Email, text and occasional calls until each item was complete.

THE RULE I FOLLOWED

Verify before chasing

Missing document	Search Drive and Leap customer files	Ask the owners if it's on their computers	Only then contact the subcontractor
Unpaid invoice	Check the bank transaction and receipt	Confirm it's really unpaid	Then follow up

> *Chasing someone for a document you already have, or an invoice that was already paid, costs the owner credibility with his subcontractors.*

EXAMPLE

A 1099 that didn’t match the payments

⚠ A company that paid the owner’s business issued a 1099 for the year that he believed didn’t reflect what was actually paid.

1

Pulled the payments

Gathered every payment that company sent during the year

2

Compared and adjusted

Compared the total to the 1099 and prepared a proposed adjustment showing the difference

3

Packaged for approval

Put the records, the original 1099 and the adjustment in one document for the owner to approve before anyone was contacted

From there, the owner took the correction to the issuer. My part was the reconciliation behind it.

What changed

Contractor paperwork was collected during the year, not rebuilt at year-end.

The owner filed 1099s from organized, verified records.

All names and figures are illustrative. No client, contractor, tax, or banking information is shown.